Alexander Dao

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Linguistics B.A. and Computer Science minor candidate at UC Santa Cruz with hands-on experience building data pipelines, AI tooling, and conducting technical research. Built a REST API and JSON data pipeline in Python to collect and serve real-time data, developed a Claude-based AI agent deployed in production across 4 Stanford course sections, and authored published research on AI workforce impact. Eager to contribute to fast-moving engineering teams that build with data.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz — Santa Cruz, CA
Linguistics B.A., Computer Science Minor. Thesis: The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia - Completed Fall 2025, advised by Prof. Dustin A. Chacon. — *Winter 2027*
Relevant Coursework: CSE 40: Machine Learning in Python, CSE 101: Data Structures and Algorithms, CSE 150: Introduction to Computer Networks, CSE 151: Advanced Computer Networks

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer Intern — Jul 2026 – Present
treemarks.ai — *Stanford, CA*
- Developed a configurable AI shell for TA grading workflows by adapting a Claude-based agent, deployed live across 4 undergraduate and graduate course sections at Stanford to several hundred users.
- Built and shipped core features for a production Python environment supporting real-time grading operations.

Intern Contributor, Tech Beat — Dec 2025 – May 2026
The American Prospect — *Santa Cruz, CA*
- Authored a published article on the impact of AI on entry-level job opportunities; conducted technical research, fact-checking, and data analysis on emerging AI technologies.

Content Analytics Intern — Jun 2024 – Jan 2025
Paystand — *Santa Cruz, CA*
- Analyzed platform performance data across TikTok, YouTube, and Twitter using Google Sheets and Excel to inform marketing strategies, reporting growth insights directly to the CEO's office.

PROJECTS

NGramLM — Aug 2026 – Present
Course Project
- Building an N-gram language model in Python that ingests articles from the Wikipedia API or local corpus documents and generates context-related text output.

SpotiLytics — Jun 2026 – Present
Data Engineer
- Built a REST API and JSON data pipeline using Python (Flask and SpotiPy) to collect Spotify listening data; investigating whether listening behavior varies by day of the week.
- Serving collected data via a static GitHub page with vanilla JS handling API handshakes; ML modeling phase in development.

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA) — Feb 2025 - Present
Member
- Peer and staff-led STEM club at UC Santa Cruz supporting underrepresented first-generation college students.

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) — Sep 2025 - Jun 2026
Member
- Professional engineering society for students from Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with NSBE and MESA chapters.

Peninsula Youth Sailing Foundation (PYSF) — Jan 2016 - Jan 2022
C420 Race Team Skipper
- Competed as a dinghy racer, training under two-time world Snipe/Elliott 6m-class champion Molly O'Brien Vandemoer and 2008 470-class Olympic bronze medalist Udi Gal.

SKILLS

Data & Tools: REST APIs, JSON pipelines, Flask, SpotiPy, Google Sheets, Excel

Programming Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, C, HTML, CSS

Research Methods: Machine Learning (Python), Psycholinguistics, Neurolinguistics

Languages: English, Vietnamese, Japanese, Latin, Spanish (basic)